07-20 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Apple Tree Behind Our School

① There is an old apple tree behind our school. It is not tall, and its fruit is small and a little sour, but every September it wears hundreds of red-and-green apples like buttons on a grandmother's coat. For years, the tree had been forgotten. No one talked about it. Then, last October, because of one very strange afternoon, everyone in Class 8B could not stop talking about it.

② It began with Mr Zhao, our geography teacher. He was a quiet man who wore the same grey jacket every day. That afternoon, the classroom was hot, the lesson was about rocks, and half of the class looked almost asleep. Suddenly Mr Zhao closed his book, looked at us for a long second, and said, "Leave your pens. Bring your shoes. We're going outside." We blinked. No one moved. "Now, please," he added, in a warm voice we had never heard before.

③ We walked in two quiet lines through the back gate to the old apple tree. Mr Zhao stopped under its twisted branches and pointed up. "This tree is sixty years old," he said. "It was planted by the first head teacher of our school, in 1967. For every class that finished Grade 9, he asked one student to come and pick one apple — not to eat, but to keep as a reminder." He smiled. "Then we all forgot. For almost thirty years."

④ The class was quiet. Even Da Wei, who usually talked more than anyone, stood still. Mr Zhao walked slowly around the tree, touching the bark. "I think," he said carefully, "it is time to start again." He asked us to pick one apple each — only one — and to write on it, with a thick pen, one small thing we hoped for ourselves by the time we finished Grade 9. Not a grade. Not a prize. Something small and true.

⑤ I stood there for a long minute, holding a red apple a little bigger than my palm. In the end, I wrote four English words: "*to be more brave*". I was surprised by my own hand. Around me, other students wrote in silence. Xiao Lin, the shyest girl in our class, wrote something so quickly that she blushed and hid her apple in her bag. Even Da Wei stopped joking and wrote carefully. When we returned to the classroom, the hot afternoon felt different — softer, a little slower.

⑥ That night, I put the apple on my desk. Within a week, of course, it began to go brown. My mother laughed kindly, threw the apple away, but kept the peel with my four words on her kitchen window. "This," she said, "is the part worth keeping." I did not fully understand her then.

⑦ Now, nine months later, the apples on the tree are still green and small. Our class will pick them again in September. I do not yet know if I have become more brave — I still feel nervous when I raise my hand, still quiet on the bus. But I know one thing. Sometimes the most powerful lesson does not come from a chalkboard. It comes from a sour, forgotten apple, a quiet teacher, and four words on a red skin that dries slowly on a window sill.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What was the writer's first feeling when Mr Zhao suddenly stopped the lesson?

A. Angry, because he loved the lesson about rocks.
B. Surprised, because no one moved at first and everyone was confused.
C. Excited, because he hated all geography lessons.
D. Afraid, because he thought he would be punished.

2. According to Mr Zhao, what was the tradition started by the first head teacher of the school?

A. Every Grade 9 student had to eat a whole apple from the tree.
B. One student from each Grade 9 class picked an apple to keep as a reminder.
C. Teachers sold the apples to earn money for the school.
D. Students had to paint the tree every year.

3. What did Mr Zhao ask the students to write on their apples?

A. A grade they wanted to get.
B. A prize they hoped to win.
C. One small, true hope for themselves by Grade 9.
D. Their full name and phone number.

4. Why did the writer's mother keep the apple peel on the kitchen window?

A. Because apple peel can be used to make tea.
B. Because the four English words written on it were worth keeping.
C. Because she wanted to show it to the neighbours.
D. Because the peel was a gift from the teacher.

5. What does the writer mainly want to tell us in the last paragraph?

A. He has already become the bravest person in the class.
B. He will never pick apples again.
C. The most powerful lessons sometimes come from small, unusual moments, not from the chalkboard.
D. Grade 9 is the hardest year of school life.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "We blinked. No one moved."
【解析】全班惊讶、困惑。A/C/D 均与原文不符。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "he asked one student to come and pick one apple... to keep as a reminder."
【解析】每届九年级一人摘一苹果作纪念。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "Not a grade. Not a prize. Something small and true."
【解析】写下一个真实的小希望。A/B 被明确排除；D 无据。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "'This,' she said, 'is the part worth keeping.'"
【解析】母亲留下写着四个英语词的果皮。A/C/D 均无据。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦段末句 "Sometimes the most powerful lesson..."
【解析】最有力的教育来自课堂外的小瞬间。A/B/D 均非主旨。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **twisted** [adj.] 弯曲的
- **bark** [n.] 树皮
- **reminder** [n.] 提醒物
- **blush** [v.] 脸红
- **sill** [n.] 窗台